

Rules and Regulations of GEARS

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This document supplements the deed of incorporation of GEARS. In the event of a conflict, the deed and applicable law prevail. This document is a governance draft and is not legal advice. ““

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1 General Provisions

1.1 Purpose

1. These Rules and Regulations (the “Rules”) govern the day-to-day organisation, operation, and conduct of GEARS.
2. The purpose of these Rules is to provide a clear framework for:
 - the organisation of GEARS projects and teams;
 - the safe use of equipment, workshops, laboratories, and other facilities;
 - the management of GEARS property and finances;
 - cooperation with sponsors, universities, companies, and other external parties;
 - the authority of members and teams to act in the name of GEARS;
 - intellectual property and project ownership;
 - communication and digital infrastructure;
 - professional and respectful conduct; and
 - the prevention and management of risks and conflicts.
3. The Rules are intended to support the mission and objectives of GEARS as established in its deed of incorporation.

1.2 Relationship with the Deed

1. The deed of incorporation of GEARS is the primary governing document of the association.
2. These Rules may elaborate on matters which are not exhaustively regulated by the deed.
3. These Rules may not contradict the deed, mandatory provisions of Dutch law, or binding rules imposed by a university, makerspace, facility owner, competition organiser, or other authority whose facilities or activities GEARS uses.
4. Where these Rules conflict with a higher-ranking rule, the higher-ranking rule prevails.
5. Where interpretation of these Rules is uncertain, the Board shall interpret them in accordance with the purpose of GEARS and the deed.

1.3 Scope

1. These Rules apply to:
 - members of GEARS;
 - Board members;
 - team managers and project leads;

- members of GEARS teams and committees;
 - volunteers acting on behalf of GEARS; and
 - other persons where they participate in GEARS activities and have been informed that these Rules apply.
2. Certain provisions, in particular those concerning safety, confidentiality, intellectual property, and use of GEARS property, may also apply after a person's membership or role has ended where relevant.

2 Membership and Participation

2.1 Participation in GEARS Activities

1. Members may participate in GEARS teams, projects, committees, events, and other activities subject to the requirements established by the responsible team or the Board.
2. Participation in a project does not by itself give a member authority to represent GEARS externally.
3. Participation in a team does not by itself create ownership of the team, its equipment, its budget, or its intellectual property.

2.2 Responsibilities of Members

Members participating in GEARS activities shall:

- comply with these Rules;
- comply with applicable laws and regulations;
- follow university, makerspace, laboratory, workshop, venue, and competition rules;
- use GEARS resources responsibly;
- report relevant safety incidents, damage, loss, or misconduct;
- respect the confidentiality of information designated as confidential;
- respect intellectual property rights;
- treat other members and external parties professionally; and
- act in the interests of GEARS when explicitly authorised to represent the association.

3 Teams and Projects

3.1 Establishment of Teams

1. A GEARS team is a project organisation operating under the association.
2. A team may be established by the Board, or in another manner approved by the Board.

3. Every officially recognised team shall have:

- a registered team name;
- a team manager or project lead;
- a defined project objective;
- a current list of active members;
- a basic project plan;
- a responsible person for financial administration;
- a responsible person for safety where appropriate; and
- a current inventory of significant GEARS-owned assets in its possession.

3.2 Team Structure

Unless the Board approves an alternative structure, teams should use the following structure:

- **Team Manager / Project Lead:** responsible for overall coordination and communication with the Board;
- **Technical Lead(s):** responsible for technical coordination where applicable;
- **Safety Responsible:** responsible for coordinating safety compliance;
- **Finance Responsible:** responsible for tracking project expenditure;
- **Members:** participants responsible for their assigned work.

A person may hold multiple roles where appropriate for the size and complexity of the team.

3.3 Team Manager Agreement

1. Every team manager shall receive a written role description or agreement.

2. The agreement shall specify, at minimum:

- the scope of the manager's authority;
- responsibilities towards the team;
- responsibilities towards the Board;
- financial responsibilities;
- safety responsibilities;
- reporting requirements;
- rules regarding external communication;
- rules regarding contracts and commitments; and
- the procedure for resignation or removal from the role.

3. A team manager may not bind GEARS contractually unless explicitly authorised under Section 10.

3.4 Name of Teams

1. Official GEARS teams shall use a consistent naming convention.
2. The default convention shall be:

GEARS - [Project Name]

3. Where relevant, the project year may be included:

GEARS - [Project Name] - [Year]

4. A team may not use a name that:
 - falsely implies legal independence from GEARS;
 - implies authority it does not possess;
 - infringes another party's intellectual property;
 - conflicts with another official GEARS team; or
 - is inappropriate or contrary to the Code of Conduct.
5. The Board maintains the official list of recognised GEARS teams.

3.5 Team Dissolution

When a team ceases to operate, the team manager shall ensure that:

- GEARS-owned equipment is returned;
- financial records are submitted;
- outstanding obligations are identified;
- relevant documentation is archived;
- digital accounts are transferred or closed;
- intellectual property records are preserved; and
- external partners are informed where necessary.

4 Testing, Training and Permits

4.1 General Principle

GEARS activities involving machinery, vehicles, electrical systems, chemicals, lasers, drones, high-voltage systems, pressurised systems, or other potentially hazardous activities may only be performed by appropriately trained and authorised persons.

4.2 Training and Testing

1. Where a facility or equipment provider requires training or certification, GEARS members shall complete the required training before using the equipment.
2. GEARS may introduce internal training and testing requirements where necessary.
3. Access to high-risk equipment may be restricted to members who have:
 - completed the required training;
 - passed any required practical or theoretical test; and
 - received explicit authorisation.
4. Training and authorisation records should be maintained where appropriate.
5. Authorisation may be suspended or withdrawn following unsafe conduct, misuse of equipment, or changes in competence.

4.3 Testing of Projects

1. Before a project is operated, demonstrated, transported, or entered into a competition, the responsible team shall determine whether testing, inspection, certification, or approval is required.
2. A project shall not be tested in a manner that creates an unreasonable risk to people, property, or the environment.
3. Testing shall be documented where the risk or complexity of the project warrants this.
4. Where an external competition, university, government authority, venue, or other organisation imposes additional testing requirements, those requirements shall be followed.

4.4 Permits and Regulatory Compliance

1. Teams are responsible for identifying permits, registrations, certifications, or approvals required for their activities.
2. Examples may include requirements concerning:
 - drones and unmanned aircraft;
 - road-going vehicles;
 - public demonstrations;
 - radio equipment;
 - lasers;
 - electrical installations;
 - chemicals;

- fire safety;
 - transport of hazardous materials; and
 - use of public space.
3. Where uncertainty exists, the team shall consult the Board and, where appropriate, the relevant university, facility manager, competition organiser, or competent authority before proceeding.

5 Safety and Facilities

5.1 General Safety Rule

1. Safety takes priority over project deadlines, competition performance, cost, or convenience.
2. All GEARS members shall comply with:
 - applicable law;
 - university safety regulations;
 - makerspace or workshop house rules;
 - facility-specific instructions;
 - equipment manuals and safety requirements; and
 - reasonable instructions of authorised safety personnel.

5.2 Makerspace and Workshop Use

1. Members may only use equipment for which they are authorised.
2. Required personal protective equipment (PPE) shall be worn.
3. Safety guards and protective systems may not be removed or bypassed without explicit authorisation for a legitimate maintenance purpose.
4. Members shall not operate dangerous machinery while impaired by alcohol, drugs, medication affecting safe operation, or fatigue to the extent that safe operation is compromised.
5. Workspaces shall be kept clean and emergency exits, fire extinguishers, electrical panels, and access routes shall remain unobstructed.
6. Equipment shall be returned to its designated location after use.

5.3 Working Alone

1. Members shall not work alone where university or makerspace rules prohibit it.
2. GEARS shall identify activities for which a second person, supervisor, or designated safety responsible is required.

3. Particularly hazardous activities shall only take place under the supervision required by the relevant facility or risk assessment.

5.4 Incident Reporting

Any member who becomes aware of:

- an injury;
- a near miss;
- equipment damage;
- fire or smoke;
- hazardous material release;
- serious safety violation; or
- another significant incident

shall report it promptly to the responsible team member and the Board, and shall follow the emergency procedures of the relevant facility.

6 BHV and Emergency Response

6.1 Emergency Procedures

1. In an emergency, immediate protection of life and prevention of further harm take priority over protection of GEARS property.
2. Members shall follow the emergency procedures of the facility in which the incident occurs.
3. Emergency exits, first-aid equipment, fire extinguishers, AEDs, and relevant emergency contact information should be known to members using GEARS facilities.

6.2 BHV / First Aid

1. GEARS shall identify appropriate first-aid and emergency-response arrangements for its activities.
2. For activities involving significant physical, chemical, electrical, mechanical, or other hazards, GEARS should ensure that appropriate emergency support is available.
3. Where GEARS organises larger or higher-risk events, the Board shall determine whether trained BHV/EHBO personnel or other emergency support is required.
4. The Board shall maintain an emergency contact procedure.

7 Inventory, Property and Ownership

7.1 GEARS Property

1. Unless explicitly agreed otherwise in writing, items purchased with GEARS funds are the property of GEARS.
2. This includes, where applicable:
 - tools;
 - machinery;
 - electronics;
 - computers;
 - vehicles;
 - components;
 - materials;
 - workshop equipment;
 - software licences; and
 - other project resources.

7.2 Sponsored and Donated Equipment

1. Sponsored or donated items shall be recorded together with the applicable ownership conditions.
2. Unless the sponsorship or donation agreement explicitly provides otherwise, donated property becomes GEARS property.
3. Teams may not promise ownership, permanent use, or transfer of GEARS property to sponsors or members without Board approval.

7.3 Inventory

1. GEARS shall maintain an inventory of significant assets.
2. Teams shall maintain an up-to-date list of significant GEARS property in their possession.
3. Items that are loaned to members shall, where appropriate, be recorded with:
 - the item;
 - responsible person;
 - date of loan;
 - expected return date; and

- condition.

7.4 Removal and Disposal

1. GEARS property may not be permanently removed from GEARS control without appropriate authorisation.
2. Disposal, sale, donation, or transfer of significant GEARS assets requires Board approval.
3. Personal property brought into GEARS facilities remains the property of its owner unless explicitly transferred.
4. GEARS is not automatically responsible for loss or damage to personal property.

8 Finance and Financial Transparency

8.1 General Principle

GEARS finances shall be managed transparently, responsibly, and in accordance with the deed, applicable law, and decisions of the competent bodies of the association.

8.2 Association Funds

1. GEARS income and expenditure shall be processed through approved GEARS financial channels.
2. Members shall not use GEARS funds for personal purposes.
3. Expenses must have a legitimate connection to GEARS activities.
4. Receipts or equivalent documentation shall be retained for expenses where appropriate.

8.3 Team Budgets

1. The Board may allocate budgets to teams.
2. A team budget remains GEARS money and does not become the personal property of the team members.
3. Teams shall maintain sufficient records to allow the Treasurer to understand how their allocated budget is used.
4. Expenditure above thresholds established by the Board requires prior approval.

8.4 Sponsorship Income and the “GEARS Cut”

1. Sponsorship income received in the name of GEARS belongs to GEARS unless a valid agreement provides otherwise.
2. Sponsorship funds shall not be privately distributed among team members.
3. The association shall maintain transparency concerning:

- the amount received;
 - the sponsor;
 - the purpose of the funding;
 - any restrictions;
 - any fees or costs; and
 - the amount allocated to the relevant project.
4. **[TO BE DECIDED: Decide whether GEARS retains a percentage of sponsorship income raised by teams.]**
 5. If GEARS retains a percentage, the percentage and its purpose shall be communicated clearly to teams before fundraising takes place.
 6. Unless otherwise decided, the recommended default is that sponsor funds intended for a specific project are used for that project, subject to reasonable association-wide costs and any agreed GEARS contribution.

8.5 Financial Reporting

1. The Treasurer shall maintain appropriate financial records.
2. Members shall receive the financial information to which they are entitled under the deed and applicable law.
3. The Board shall provide sufficient information to allow members to understand the financial position and significant expenditures of GEARS.
4. Financial confidentiality may be maintained where disclosure would breach privacy, contractual confidentiality, or other legitimate obligations.

9 Sponsorships and External Partnerships

9.1 Sponsorship Policy

1. Sponsorships shall support the purpose and reputation of GEARS.
2. A sponsorship may not require GEARS or a team to violate law, competition rules, university rules, ethical standards, or these Rules.
3. The Board shall approve sponsorship agreements entered into in the name of GEARS.
4. Sponsors shall receive clearly defined benefits.

9.2 Sponsor Benefits

Sponsor benefits may include, where appropriate:

- logo placement;

- website visibility;
- event visibility;
- project updates;
- presentations;
- demonstrations;
- recruitment-related activities; or
- other agreed benefits.

Sponsor benefits shall not give a sponsor control over GEARS's governance, membership decisions, safety decisions, or independent project decisions unless expressly approved under a separate agreement.

9.3 Conflicts of Interest

The Board may reject or terminate a sponsorship where the relationship would create a material conflict with GEARS's purpose, university obligations, competition rules, or reputation.

10 Contracts and Authority

10.1 Authority to Bind GEARS

1. Only persons who have authority under the deed and/or have been properly authorised by the competent body may enter into agreements on behalf of GEARS.
2. Team membership, team management, Board membership, or another internal role does not automatically confer authority to sign contracts on behalf of GEARS.
3. In particular, members shall not independently sign:
 - sponsorship agreements;
 - purchase agreements of significant value;
 - rental agreements;
 - employment or contractor agreements;
 - intellectual-property licences;
 - liability waivers;
 - partnership agreements; or
 - other agreements that create legal obligations for GEARS.
4. **[TO BE DECIDED: Confirm exact signing/representation requirements against Article 18 of the deed.]**

10.2 Internal Authorisation

1. Where a contract requires Board approval, the approval should be documented in the minutes or another durable record.
2. The Board may delegate limited signing authority in writing.
3. A delegation shall specify:
 - the person authorised;
 - the type of agreement;
 - any financial limit;
 - the period of validity; and
 - any conditions.

10.3 Unauthorised Agreements

A member who purports to bind GEARS without authority may be personally responsible for the consequences of their actions to the extent permitted by law. The Board shall investigate and, where necessary, take corrective action.

10.4 Standard Contracts

GEARS shall maintain standard templates for recurring agreements, including where relevant:

- sponsorship agreements;
- equipment loan agreements;
- volunteer or team-manager agreements;
- collaboration agreements;
- confidentiality agreements;
- event participation agreements; and
- intellectual-property agreements.

11 Liability and Risk

11.1 General Principle

1. GEARS shall take reasonable measures to reduce risks associated with its activities.
2. Members remain responsible for complying with applicable safety instructions and acting with reasonable care.
3. No provision in these Rules shall be interpreted as excluding liability where such exclusion is prohibited by law.

11.2 Project Responsibility

1. Teams shall identify foreseeable risks associated with their projects.
2. Projects involving significant safety, legal, financial, or reputational risk require Board review before external deployment where reasonably appropriate.
3. A team may not represent that GEARS guarantees the safety, legality, certification, or performance of a project unless this has been formally established.

11.3 Disclaimer

GEARS facilitates student projects, competitions, education, collaboration, and technical development. Participation in a GEARS activity does not constitute a guarantee that a project, product, design, test, or prototype is safe, certified, legally approved, competition-compliant, or suitable for use outside its intended testing environment.

Members and external participants remain responsible for complying with applicable laws, regulations, safety requirements, manufacturer instructions, competition rules, and facility rules. Nothing in these Rules limits any liability that cannot legally be limited or excluded.

12 Intellectual Property

12.1 General Principle

1. GEARS respects the intellectual property rights of its members, sponsors, universities, competition organisers, and other third parties.
2. Members shall not knowingly use, reproduce, distribute, or disclose third-party intellectual property without the required permission.

12.2 Member-Created Work

1. **[TO BE DECIDED: GEARS must decide its default IP model.]**
2. The default model should be documented clearly for each team before substantial project work begins.
3. Possible models include:
 - (a) the creator retains ownership and grants GEARS a licence;
 - (b) GEARS owns specified project IP;
 - (c) ownership is shared or governed by a separate agreement; or
 - (d) ownership is determined by sponsor, university, or competition agreements.

4. No member shall be required to transfer intellectual property to GEARS merely by participating unless this is clearly established by an applicable agreement.

12.3 Sponsor and University IP

Where a sponsor, university, competition organiser, or other party has contractual IP requirements, those requirements shall be reviewed before project work is committed.

12.4 Publication and Confidentiality

1. Members shall not disclose confidential sponsor, partner, competition, or GEARS information without authorisation.
2. Public disclosure of technical information shall take into account:
 - confidentiality obligations;
 - patent or other IP considerations;
 - competition rules; and
 - privacy requirements.

13 Website, Email and Digital Infrastructure

13.1 Official Accounts

1. Official GEARS websites, domains, email addresses, social-media accounts, repositories, cloud storage, and other digital infrastructure are organisational resources of GEARS.
2. Individual members shall not claim personal ownership of official accounts or data.
3. Administrative access shall be maintained by the Board or persons appointed by the Board.

13.2 Email

Official GEARS communication should use official GEARS email accounts where practical.

Examples include:

board@...	Board communication	treasurer@...
Financial communication	teams@...	Team/project communication
Team-specific communication		[team-name]@...

[TO BE DECIDED: Insert official GEARS domain and final email naming convention.]

13.3 Website

The website should contain, where appropriate:

- information about GEARS;

- recognised teams and projects;
- contact information;
- relevant policies;
- sponsor information;
- public project information; and
- other information approved for publication.

13.4 Account Handover

When a Board member, team manager, webmaster, or other administrator leaves their role:

- access credentials shall be transferred;
- recovery information shall be updated;
- unnecessary personal access shall be removed; and
- relevant data shall be handed over to the successor.

14 Board, Meetings and Confidential Information

14.1 Board Meetings

1. Board meetings shall be conducted in accordance with the deed.
2. Decisions requiring a formal Board decision shall be recorded.
3. Minutes shall record relevant decisions, responsibilities, and follow-up actions.

14.2 Board Room / Board Workspace

1. The designated Board room or Board workspace is primarily intended for official GEARS governance and administration.
2. Confidential documents, financial records, personal information, contracts, and other sensitive information shall be stored securely.
3. Access to confidential Board materials shall be limited to persons with a legitimate reason to access them.
4. The Board may establish additional practical rules for use of the room.

14.3 Confidentiality

Members with access to confidential information shall:

- use it only for legitimate GEARS purposes;
- not disclose it without authorisation;

- store it appropriately; and
- return or delete it when no longer required, subject to applicable record-keeping obligations.

15 Code of Conduct

15.1 Expected Conduct

GEARS aims to provide an environment in which members can collaborate, learn, build, compete, and develop projects in a respectful and safe manner.

Members shall:

- treat others with respect;
- communicate professionally;
- respect personal boundaries;
- respect differences in background, identity, experience, and ability;
- follow safety instructions;
- respect GEARS property;
- act honestly in financial and technical matters; and
- raise concerns through appropriate channels.

15.2 Prohibited Conduct

GEARS does not tolerate:

- harassment;
- discrimination;
- intimidation;
- threats or violence;
- sexual harassment;
- deliberate sabotage;
- theft or misuse of GEARS property;
- serious or deliberate safety violations;
- fraud or financial misconduct;
- unauthorised disclosure of confidential information; or
- deliberate misuse of GEARS's name or reputation.

15.3 Alcohol and Drugs

1. Alcohol and drugs may not be used in circumstances where they compromise safety or responsible conduct.
2. Alcohol or drugs may never be used while operating machinery or performing safety-critical work.
3. Facility-specific rules always apply.

16 Confidential Advisors and Reporting

16.1 Confidential Advisor

1. GEARS should appoint at least one confidential advisor (*vertrouwenspersoon*) who can provide a confidential first point of contact for members experiencing or witnessing inappropriate behaviour.
2. The confidential advisor should operate independently from ordinary disciplinary decision-making.
3. The advisor may:
 - listen to concerns;
 - explain available options;
 - assist a member in finding appropriate support;
 - facilitate contact with relevant university or external support services; and
 - advise the Board on general safeguarding measures without unnecessarily disclosing confidential details.
4. The identity and contact details of the confidential advisor shall be made available to members.
5. Confidentiality is subject to applicable law and situations in which disclosure is legally required or necessary to prevent serious harm.

16.2 Reporting Misconduct

Concerns may be reported to:

- a Board member;
- the confidential advisor;
- a team manager;
- an appropriate university contact; or
- another designated reporting channel.

17 Conflicts of Interest

1. Members and Board members shall disclose relevant conflicts of interest when making decisions on behalf of GEARS.
2. A conflict may arise, for example, where a person has a personal, financial, academic, employment, or family interest in a proposed transaction.
3. A person with a material conflict should not participate in the relevant decision unless their participation is appropriate and permitted under the deed and applicable law.
4. Conflicts and the way they were handled should be documented for significant decisions.

18 Procurement and Purchases

1. Purchases made with GEARS funds shall serve a legitimate GEARS purpose.
2. The Board may establish spending limits and approval thresholds.
3. Significant purchases should, where practical, be compared between multiple suppliers.
4. Members shall not intentionally divide a purchase into smaller transactions to circumvent an approval threshold.
5. Purchases involving a member or a related party shall be disclosed and approved in accordance with the conflict-of-interest provisions.

19 Events and External Activities

1. Teams organising public events, demonstrations, workshops, or competition-related activities shall assess relevant organisational, financial, legal, and safety requirements in advance.
2. External activities conducted in GEARS's name require appropriate approval.
3. The organiser shall identify:
 - venue requirements;
 - insurance or liability requirements;
 - emergency arrangements;
 - permits;
 - participant registration;
 - financial arrangements; and
 - relevant privacy requirements.

20 Data Protection and Privacy

1. GEARS shall handle personal information responsibly and in accordance with applicable data-protection law.
2. Personal information shall only be collected and used for legitimate purposes.
3. Access to personal information shall be limited to persons who need it for their role.
4. Public publication of member information, photographs, contact details, or other personal information shall be handled in accordance with applicable privacy requirements.
5. **[TO BE DECIDED: GEARS should adopt a separate privacy policy if it processes significant amounts of personal data.]**

21 Disciplinary Measures

21.1 General

Where a member violates these Rules, the deed, applicable law, or serious safety requirements, GEARS may take appropriate measures in accordance with the authority granted by the deed and applicable law.

21.2 Possible Measures

Depending on the nature and seriousness of the matter, measures may include:

- informal warning;
- formal warning;
- temporary restriction from a project;
- suspension of equipment access;
- removal from a team role;
- suspension from specific GEARS activities; or
- other measures permitted under the deed and applicable law.

21.3 Membership Sanctions

Any suspension or termination of membership shall follow the procedure and authority specified in the deed and applicable law.

21.4 Fair Procedure

Before serious disciplinary measures are taken, the person concerned should normally:

- be informed of the concern;
- have a reasonable opportunity to respond; and

- receive information about the decision and, where applicable, available appeal or review procedures.

22 Intellectual and Material Legacy of Teams

When members graduate, leave GEARS, or leave a team, the team shall ensure continuity by transferring:

- project documentation;
- source code and design files;
- relevant credentials;
- inventory information;
- sponsor documentation;
- testing records;
- safety documentation; and
- other information necessary for continuation.

This does not transfer ownership of intellectual property unless the applicable agreement provides for such transfer.

23 Amendment of the Rules

1. These Rules may be amended by the competent body in accordance with the deed.
2. Amendments shall be communicated to members.
3. Amendments shall not be used to override provisions of the deed.
4. The Board should review these Rules at least once per year and after significant changes to:
 - the organisation of GEARS;
 - its facilities;
 - its activities;
 - relevant university rules;
 - applicable law; or
 - the risk profile of its projects.

24 Final Provisions

1. Every member shall have reasonable access to the current version of these Rules.
2. The current version shall be stored in the official GEARS digital repository.

3. If a provision of these Rules is found to be invalid or unenforceable, the remaining provisions remain in effect to the extent permitted by law.
4. These Rules enter into force on **[TO BE DECIDED: effective date]**.

A Appendix A – Team Manager Agreement

This appendix is intended as a template and should be adapted to each team.

GEARS Team Manager Agreement

Team: [TO BE DECIDED: Team name]
Manager: [TO BE DECIDED: Name]
Start date: [TO BE DECIDED: Date]
Expected end date: [TO BE DECIDED: Date]

The Team Manager agrees to:

1. coordinate the team's activities;
2. maintain communication with the Board;
3. ensure compliance with GEARS Rules;
4. ensure appropriate safety procedures;
5. maintain or delegate responsibility for the project budget;
6. maintain an appropriate project inventory;
7. ensure that external commitments are approved;
8. maintain project documentation;
9. ensure appropriate handover when leaving the role; and
10. immediately report serious incidents or conflicts to the Board.

The Team Manager does not have authority to bind GEARS contractually unless separately authorised.

Signature Team Manager:

Signature GEARS representative: [1cm] —

Date:

Date:

B Appendix B – Standard Sponsorship Agreement

Every sponsorship agreement should, where relevant, specify:

1. the legal parties;
2. the duration;
3. the amount or value of sponsorship;
4. payment schedule;
5. the project or team receiving support;
6. sponsor benefits;
7. logo and branding rights;
8. intellectual-property arrangements;
9. confidentiality;
10. publication rights;
11. liability;
12. termination;
13. applicable law;
14. dispute resolution; and
15. authorised signatories.

[TO BE DECIDED: Create a separate legally reviewed sponsorship contract template.]

C Appendix C – Equipment Loan Form

Item: [TO BE DECIDED:]
Inventory number: [TO BE DECIDED:]
Borrower: [TO BE DECIDED:]
Date issued: [TO BE DECIDED:]
Expected return: [TO BE DECIDED:]
Condition: [TO BE DECIDED:]

The borrower agrees to:

- use the item only for its intended purpose;
- follow applicable safety instructions;
- take reasonable care of the item;
- report damage or loss promptly; and
- return the item upon request or at the agreed date.

Signature borrower: _____

Date: _____

D Appendix D – Minimum Project Registration

Every officially recognised GEARS project should record:

Field	Information
Project name	
Team manager	
Team members	
Project objective	
Competition / external partner	
Expected duration	
Estimated budget	
Funding sources	
Major GEARS assets used	
Safety risks	
Required training	
Required permits / certification	
IP considerations	
Sponsor agreements	
External contracts	
Testing plan	

E Appendix E – Issues Requiring GEARS Decisions

The following matters should be explicitly decided before final adoption:

1. What percentage, if any, of sponsorship income raised by teams is retained by GEARS?
2. What spending thresholds require Board approval?
3. Which persons may sign which types of contracts?
4. What exact representation/signing arrangement applies under Article 18 of the deed?
5. What is GEARS's default intellectual-property model?
6. Which team activities require Board approval before starting?
7. Which equipment requires internal GEARS certification?
8. Who is responsible for safety coordination?
9. Who are the confidential advisors?
10. What is the official GEARS domain and email naming convention?
11. What information must teams report to the Board and how frequently?
12. What is the process for creating and dissolving teams?
13. What are the exact disciplinary powers of the Board?
14. What insurance coverage does GEARS have, and what activities are excluded?
15. Which university and makerspace rules are directly binding on GEARS members?
16. What records must be retained when a project or team ends?
17. Which documents require legal review before adoption?

F Appendix F – Quick Reference for Members

Before starting a project:

1. Register the team/project.
2. Appoint a team manager.
3. Agree on the project objective and structure.
4. Identify safety risks.
5. Identify required training and permits.
6. Determine the budget and funding sources.
7. Determine IP ownership and confidentiality requirements.
8. Check whether contracts or sponsor agreements are required.

Before buying something:

1. Confirm that the purchase serves a GEARS purpose.
2. Confirm that budget is available.
3. Follow the applicable approval threshold.
4. Keep the receipt.
5. Register significant equipment in the inventory.

Before signing something:

1. Do not sign in the name of GEARS unless authorised.
2. Send the agreement to the appropriate Board representative.
3. Check financial obligations.
4. Check liability.
5. Check intellectual property.
6. Check confidentiality.
7. Check duration and termination.

Before using dangerous equipment:

1. Complete required training.
2. Pass required testing.
3. Confirm authorisation.
4. Follow university/makerspace rules.
5. Wear required PPE.

6. Do not work alone where prohibited.
7. Stop work if conditions become unsafe.